

JOHNY ESKANDAR

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EDUCATION

Washington University in St. Louis

St. Louis, MO

Bachelor of Science in Business and Computer Science (GPA: 3.86)

Expected May 2027

- **Relevant Courses:** Data Structures & Algorithms, Object-Oriented Development, Artificial Intelligence, Neural Networks

EXPERIENCE

LinkedIn - Ads Measurement

Mountain View, CA

Software Engineering Intern

May 2026 – August 2026

- Architected a **Python/PyMC certification platform** for B2B marketing-mix models, generating **synthetic data** with known ground-truth outcomes across **30 stress scenarios** and validating results against **11 accuracy and reliability guardrails**
- Integrated the certification platform into **GitHub Actions CI/CD**, automatically benchmarking every pull request against baseline performance for a **7-engineer team**, evaluating **80 PRs** and catching **3 regressions before merge**
- Built the platform's **data output layer** for **open-source** release, a schema-validated **JSON API** and **CLI** feeding automated Excel reports, interactive Jupyter notebooks, and Power BI dashboards to help advertisers optimize performance and budgets
- Diagnosed model reliability issues through **170,000 Monte Carlo simulations** and controlled experiments, uncovering an **adstock transformation defect** and **feature collinearity** that led to a merged fix preventing misleading accuracy claims

Mastercard - Decision Insights

O'Fallon, MO

Software Engineering Intern

June 2025 – August 2025

- Created a **fraud accuracy dashboard** using **SQL**, **QVDs**, and **Qlik** to analyze **550M+ daily transactions** from Mastercard's Safety Net dataset, comparing acceptance and decline rates of flagged transactions by region, card type, and merchant
- Developed an interactive **Angular** and **JavaScript** frontend for the dashboard using **Qlik REST APIs**, facilitating real-time access to KPIs, charts, and filters for **70,000+ internal stakeholders** and external clients through a scalable web interface
- Selected as **1 of 6 interns** (out of **200+**) for Mastercard's **NAM Intern Committee** as social media lead, praised by the **CEO**

Whiting-Turner

Irvine, CA

Product Management and Analytics Intern

December 2023 – May 2025

- Built a **Power BI** dashboard for a **\$2B** healthcare project, enabling 30 workers to ensure **100%** on-time delivery of 624 pods
- Spearheaded **product strategy** for two construction tech products, identifying a **\$400K growth opportunity** and reducing rework by **25%** through user research and roadmap planning
- Constructed **Power BI** dashboards for **15+ project teams**, saving **30 hours** of work per week and enabling **100+ end users**

PROJECTS

Geometry of LLM Refusal | *Python, PyTorch, Hugging Face, Qwen-1.8B-Chat, SORRY-Bench*

April 2026

- Investigated whether LLM refusal is mediated by a single direction or a cone in activation space, extracting refusal directions in **PyTorch** across **4 harm categories** on **Qwen-1.8B-Chat** using **SORRY-Bench** prompts
- Identified **layer 14** as the strongest refusal layer via **activation steering**, achieving **84-96%** cross-category ablation bypass rates and **0.735-0.892** cosine similarity, supporting a **conic subspace** framing over a single-direction hypothesis

UnveilAI – Google DevFest WashU (Top 10 of 42 teams) | *Next.js, FastAPI, Google Gemini, Bland AI*

April 2025

- Led a 4-person team to build UnveilAI, a full-stack platform with a **Next.js** frontend that ingests **GitHub repos**, generates **Gemini-powered** code explanations, and enables real-time phone conversations with an AI senior engineer via **Bland AI**
- Designed a scalable **FastAPI** backend to process user-uploaded repos and run **Gemini-powered** explanations, powering a file tree interface and chat system for structured AI code Q&A

Blendify | *Next.js, TypeScript, Spotify API*

April 2025

- Built a full-stack music app in **Next.js** and **TypeScript** that lets users log in via **Spotify OAuth**, select seed tracks, and generate custom playlists using genre and artist-based recommendations
- Designed and deployed modular **RESTful APIs** handling playlist creation, token-authenticated user data, and genre-based search, then built a responsive **TailwindCSS** UI with playlist previews and error handling

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

WashU Data Science Network

St. Louis, MO

Co-Founder and Vice President

August 2024 – December 2025

- **Co-founded** WashU's first Data Science Club, organizing resume reviews, a guest talk from a **Meta** data scientist, a data science office tour at **Hunter Engineering**, and career support for **100+ members** exploring real-world data science fields

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Languages:** Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, C++, Java, PHP, HTML/CSS
- **Frameworks & Libraries:** React, Angular, Next.js, FastAPI, Node.js, TailwindCSS, PyMC, PyTorch, TensorFlow, Pandas
- **Tools & Platforms:** Git, GitHub Actions, Docker, Cursor, Claude Code, AWS, REST APIs, Qlik, Power BI, MySQL